

Under the hood: Alienware Aurora R15

Pujan Chadha talks about the Dell's latest offering – Alienware Aurora R15

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A part from being a gamer's dream come true, the Alienware Aurora R15 is a beast of a machine that brings together the latest and fastest gaming hardware available today. We caught up with Pujan Chadha from Alienware, on what makes the Alienware Aurora R15 stand out and how is it positioned to capture the flag when it comes to appealing to hardcore gamers (with deep pockets).

Q It's great to see Alienware continuing to push the envelope when it comes to high-performance gaming desktops and bringing them to India. We've been a fan of the Aurora R15 design and we see that Alienware has mostly continued with the same design on the outside. The internals seems to have gotten a substantial upgrade on the cooling front. Can you share more details on the changes? Has the Alienware Cryo-tech seen an upgrade as well?

A Alienware represents the legacy, and our aim is constant innovation and luxury experience. The Aurora R15 has witnessed substantial internal and external improvements. Externally, the clear side panel now gets hexagonal array perforations improving the cooling of the product. This is directly over the GPU and therefore allows 19 per cent more airflow through the system. Internally, the new device has 240mm heat exchangers as compared to the 120 mm heat exchangers in the previous generation. The 240mm



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radiator/dual 120mm fans increase thermal capacity for pushing more power through next-gen Core CPUs while increasing opportunities for successful overclocking. The current generation supports the best-in-class 1350-watt power supply as against a 750-watt power supply to all the components. For a good measure, the higher-wattage fans, and a larger heat exchanger also helps in accommodating the NVIDIA® RTX 4090 GPU per se. Speaking of the GPU, the new architecture, new power levels, and new manufacturing all add up to a greater performance for high-refresh gaming at 4K, 5K, and 8K resolutions. A 1350W 80 PLUS Platinum PSU ensures

plenty of capacity for high-end components with minimal power lost as heat, requiring less cooling, and potentially bringing noise down as well. We have also improved the acoustics with bigger five fans of 120 mm chassis implying that even if the device is cranked up all the way the decibels generated are much lower getting you better airflow. The Aurora R15 runs 32 per cent quieter than the previous generation on GPU-intensive tasks and 66 per cent quieter during CPU-intensive tasks. This has been achieved by also delivering 32 per cent more CPU performance generation because of the core 13th Gen Intel® Core™ i9 CPUs, which are much more powerful.

Q What kind of performance boost does the Aurora R15 bring in comparison to the previous gen?

A The Alienware Aurora R15 has been re-engineered to prioritize speed, performance, and gameplay. The new 12-phase regulation, which is double that of the previous Aurora, improves overclocking during extended periods of gameplay. It works in tandem with heatsinks and therefore helps users perform at their peak for hours on end. As for the performance, at an overall level, it delivers 68 per cent more power at 5 per cent lower CPU temperatures.

Q How upgradeable is the Aurora R15 as it uses a custom motherboard design?

A There are 2 RAM slots and each of these can be overclocked. For storage, one can have up to 4TB of SSD and an HDD slot – so 2 SSD slots and one HDD slot for all the upgrades. Currently, we offer it with the 512 GB of SSD plus a 1TB of hard drive solution in that model that we've launched but users can upgrade it up to 4TB SSD. Similarly, the memory is upgradeable up to 64 GB (2 X 32 GB) of RAM. Additionally, the device also supports XMP memory and memory overclocking, which can be accomplished on the Alienware Command Centre.